

Skills Summary

Ten-Frames: How Many Do You See?

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

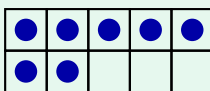
1. Say how many the frame shows

The frame. Two rows of five boxes. A **full row** is 5. A **full frame** is 10.

The shortcut. When the top row is full, say “five” and then count on for the dots below — six, seven, eight. You never have to start again at one.

First look, then count: is the top row really full?

Example: How many dots?

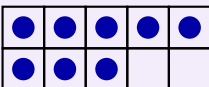


Step 1. The top row is full, so it is worth five without counting it one dot at a time.

Step 2. Count on for the bottom row: “six, seven”. That is $5 + 2$.

The last number said is the answer: **7** dots.

Try it: How many dots?



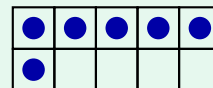
check: 8

2. How many more make ten?

The idea. The empty boxes show what is missing. Count the dots, then count the empty boxes — together they always make 10.

So “how many more?” can be answered two ways: count the empty boxes, or think “what goes with this number to make ten?”

Example: How many more dots would fill this frame?

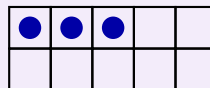


Step 1. The question is about the empty boxes, so find how many dots are there first: $5 + 1 = 6$.

Step 2. Ten boxes in all, six of them filled, so the empty ones are what is left — and they can simply be counted: four.

$\Rightarrow$ **4** more dots.

Try it: How many more dots would fill this frame?



check: 7

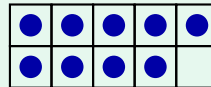
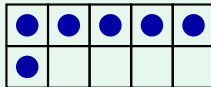
3. Which frame shows more?

The rule. Finish *both* counts first, then compare the two numbers.

$>$ means *is greater than* $<$ means *is less than* $=$ means *is the same as*

The open end of the sign always faces the bigger number. Two frames can look different and still be equal.

Example: Write $>$ or $<$:

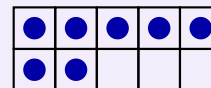
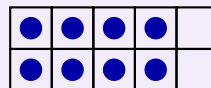


Step 1. Nothing can be compared until each frame has one number, so count both frames before choosing a sign.

Step 2. Left frame: $5 + 1 = 6$. Right frame: $5 + 4 = 9$. Six is less than nine.

$\Rightarrow <$

Try it: Write $>$, $<$ or $=$:



$<$ check

(!) Watch out: the five-shortcut only works when the top row is *full*. If the top row has gaps, count every dot. And read the question twice — “how many dots?” and “how many empty boxes?” have different answers for the same picture.